

Freedom to Speak Up Policy

Speak up, listen up, follow up

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Policy Lead(s):	Suzanne Lawlor
Designation:	Freedom to Speak Up Guardian
Responsible Director:	Chief People Officer
EIA Assessed (date):	20/11/2022
Target Audience:	All workers (including students, trainees, locums, bank and agency, contractors, volunteers, and former workers)
Approved By:	Joint Negotiating and Consultative Committee
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Ratification Date:	05/07/2023
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If printed, copied or otherwise transferred from the Intranet, Trust-wide Corporate Business Records will be considered uncontrolled copies. Staff must always consult the most up to date version which is on the Intranet.

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1. Introduction

By speaking up at work you will be playing a vital role in helping us to keep improving our services for all patients and the working environment for our staff. The [NHS People Promise](#) commits to ensuring that “we each have a voice that counts, that we all feel safe and confident to speak up, and take the time to really listen to understand the hopes and fears that lie behind the words”.

This policy is for all workers, and we want to hear all our workers’ concerns, whichever part of the organisation you work in. We know some groups in our workforce feel they are seldom heard or are reluctant to speak up. You could be an agency worker, bank worker, locum, or student. We also know that workers with disabilities, or from a minority ethnic background or the LGBTQ+ community can face additional barriers to speaking up. This policy aims to break down those barriers.

We ask all our workers to complete the online training modules relevant to their role. See [Section 8](#) for further details about training available.

You can find out more about what Freedom to Speak Up (FTSU) is in these [videos](#) and more information about speaking up in CWPT on the [Trust intranet](#).

Our guiding principles:

- We welcome speaking up because it helps keep patients safe and helps us identify opportunities for improvement that we might not otherwise know about.
- We speak up and listen up in the spirit of our Trust values
 - showing kindness and compassion
 - respecting different views and experiences
 - finding solutions together
 - focusing on what we can learn and do better
 - acting with honesty and integrity
- We expect all colleagues to create a psychologically safe environment, where speaking up is business as usual
- We can expect to be thanked and treated with dignity and respect when we speak up
- We appreciate speaking up can affect people in different ways and will do all we can to support everyone fairly and with compassion
- We will not tolerate anyone being prevented or deterred from speaking up or being mistreated because they have spoken up.



2. Purpose

- 2.1** This purpose of this policy is to help normalise speaking up for the benefit of patients and workers and ensure all matters raised are captured and considered appropriately whether raised informally or formally.
- 2.2** It sets out the principles we adhere to and the different responsibilities we hold to speak up, listen up and follow up.
- 2.3** Section 5 describes the process, explaining how to speak up and how we will listen up and follow up. More guidance can be found in the Speak Up Toolkit

2.4 If the matter is urgent, please contact the appropriate manager as soon as possible – use the on-call manager out of hours who will escalate as needed to the senior/exec on call.

2.5 If the concerns relate to a safety matter that did or could have caused harm, please ensure an incident form is completed and a safeguarding alert is raised where appropriate. You can still speak up about the matter.

2.6 Who can speak up?

Anyone who works in NHS healthcare, including pharmacy, optometry, and dentistry. This encompasses any healthcare professionals, non-clinical workers, receptionists, directors, managers, contractors, volunteers, students, trainees, junior doctors, locum, bank and agency workers, and former workers.

2.7 What can I speak up about?

2.7.1 You can speak up about **anything** that gets in the way of good patient care or positive staff experience. That could be something which doesn't feel right to you: for example:

- a way of working or a process that puts patients at risk
- inappropriate, discriminatory, unprofessional behaviour or actions that affect patient care, or the safety and wellbeing of you or colleagues

2.7.2 Speaking up captures a range of issues, some of which may be appropriate for other existing processes (for example, safeguarding, patient safety, or employee relations/HR) That's fine. We will listen and work with you to identify the most appropriate way of responding to the issues raised.

3. Definitions

3.1 Psychological safety

"a climate in which people are comfortable being and expressing themselves" and "a belief that one will not be punished or humiliated for speaking up with ideas, questions, concerns or mistakes" (*Amy Edmondson*)

3.2 Disadvantageous or demeaning treatment

Disadvantageous can be defined as unfavourable circumstances that reduce the chances of success or effectiveness. Demeaning can be defined as causing someone to become or feel less respected.

4. Duties / Responsibilities

4.1 All workers

Whatever our role, we all share a responsibility to:

- create a psychologically safe environment, where speaking up is business as usual
- speak up and raise concerns as early as possible so action may be taken to resolve them

- adhere to our professional code of conduct (where applicable) by speaking up if we see instances of wrongdoing or poor practice
- uphold the principles of the [NHS Constitution](#) in relation to raising concerns
- use the Trust incident reporting procedure where necessary
- treat our colleagues well when they speak up
- listen up and learn from speaking up

4.2 Managers and Leads

In addition to the above, managers and leads at all levels across our Trust have a responsibility to:

- regularly invite colleagues to speak up and create opportunities to hear views and ideas as part of normal team business
- listen to understand any issues raised and different perspectives
- take concerns seriously
- show appreciation and thank colleagues for speaking up
- ensure colleagues who speak up have access to appropriate support
- take prompt action to resolve the concern, seeking support of others where needed (including the freedom to speak up guardian) to plan what happens next
- keep colleagues who speak up regularly informed and provide feedback on outcomes
- reassure colleagues they should not experience any disadvantageous or demeaning treatment because they have spoken up and ask them to report it if this does happen
- seek feedback on the speak up experience
- identify and share the learning opportunities speaking up presents

4.3 Freedom to Speak Up Guardian

Whilst employed by the Trust, the Freedom to Speak Up Guardian operates independently, impartially, and objectively, whilst working in partnership with individuals and groups throughout the organisation, including senior leaders.

The guardian has a responsibility to:

- work alongside the Trust leadership team to support a healthy speak up culture
- provide advice and support to colleagues at all levels to ensure they can speak up, are listened to and treated well
- ensure concerns are shared with appropriate leadership colleagues
- provide advice and support managers to listen and respond appropriately when colleagues speak up
- ensure that people who speak up are thanked for speaking up, that the issues they raise are responded to, and that the person speaking up receives feedback on the actions taken
- maintain confidential records when people speak up
- provide bi-annual reports on speak up matters to the Safety and Quality Committee and Trust Board
- contribute towards the sharing of learning and quality improvement initiatives
- escalate to the Chief Nursing Officer, any concerns about perceived experiences of disadvantageous or demeaning treatment as a result of speaking up

4.4 Speak Up Champions

Speak Up Champions come from a wide variety of backgrounds and roles and help embed a positive speak up culture. The role is voluntary and open to all.

Champions are there to:

- raise the profile of speaking up, share information and act as a positive role model
- help colleagues understand how they can speak up, who they can speak up to, and what they should expect to happen.
- signpost colleagues to sources of support including the Freedom to Speak Up Guardian
- help reach all staff across the trust and ensure colleagues who may face additional barriers are able to speak up. (e.g., B.A.M.E., disabled, LGBTQ+, agency/NHSP, students, volunteers)

4.5 Human Resources (HR) Colleagues

HR colleagues have a responsibility to:

- support and encourage colleagues who want to speak up
- raise matters on behalf of colleagues where appropriate
- identify and share speak up matters that come to their attention with the Freedom to Speak Up Guardian

4.6 Representatives of Trade Unions and Professional Associations

Representatives will:

- encourage colleagues to speak up and raise concerns at the earliest possible opportunity
- raise matters on behalf of colleagues where appropriate
- support their members to ensure concerns are properly considered and are appropriately supported by our organisation.

4.7 Chief Nursing Officer

As the designated **Lead Director for Freedom to Speak Up**, our Chief Nursing Officer has a responsibility to:

- provide senior support for the Freedom to Speak Up Guardian
- review the effectiveness of our freedom to speak up arrangements.

4.8 Lead Non-Executive Director for Freedom to Speak Up

The designated non-executive director has a responsibility to:

- provide more independent support for the Freedom to Speak Up Guardian
- provide a fresh pair of eyes to ensure that investigations are conducted with rigor
- help to escalate issues where needed

4.9 Chief Executive

The Chief Executive has ultimate accountability for the Trust's speaking up arrangements. Operational responsibility has been delegated to the Chief Nursing Officer.

5. **Process** **Speaking Up**

5.1 **Who can I speak up to?**

5.1.1 **Speaking up internally**

Most speaking up happens through everyday conversations with colleagues, supervisors and line managers where issues are raised more informally and often resolved quickly. We strive for a culture where that is normal, everyday practice and encourage you to speak to your line manager first – it may well be the easiest and simplest way of resolving matters.

However, there are other people you can speak to if:

- for whatever reason you feel unable to raise it with your line manager
- you wish to seek some advice and support
- you feel it is more appropriate to raise the matter with somebody else, or
- you feel the matter has not been resolved having previously raised it

Other people you can speak to:

- Anyone in a leadership position including senior managers, professional leads, and directors
- Our Patient Safety team where concerns relate to patient care, safety, or quality. patientsafety@covwarkpt.nhs.uk Tel: 024 7658 8826
- Our Safeguarding Team where concerns relate to potential safeguarding issues CWP-TR.Safeguarding@nhs.net Tel: 024 7658 8816
- Our Medicines Management team, where concerns relate to medicines and pharmacy Medicines.Management@covwarkpt.nhs.uk Tel: 02476 536 836
- Our local Counter Fraud team where concerns relate to potential fraud. richard.loydall@nhs.net Tel: 07887 557496 or 024 7653 6871
- Our HR team of business partners and advisors where concerns relate to worker experience or conduct HR.enquiries@covwarkpt.nhs.uk Tel: 024 7684 4183
- Our Head of Equality, Diversity and Inclusion for matters relating to equality and inclusion rano.bains@covwarkpt.nhs.uk Tel: 024 7653 6802
- Our Freedom to Speak Up Guardian, Suzanne Lawlor, who can support you to speak up or if you are unsure about what to do and wish to seek confidential advice. You can contact the Guardian at any time in the process. Suzanne.Lawlor@covwarkpt.nhs.uk Tel: 024 7658 8861 or 07557 589 071
- Our executive lead responsible for Freedom to Speak Up, Jason Emerson Jason.Emerson@covwarkpt.nhs.uk
- Our non-executive director responsible for Freedom to Speak Up, Bal Claire Balbir.Claire@covwarkpt.nhs.uk
- Our Speak Up Champions can signpost you to the relevant person or process.
- You can find more information about Speak Up Champions on the Trust intranet.

Or complete a confidential online form which comes directly to the Freedom to Speak Up Guardian:

- You can choose to remain anonymous or share your name with the guardian in confidence.
- Follow [this link](#) or scan the QR code.



5.1.2 Speaking up externally (to someone who is not your employer or the responsible person for a service)

If you believe it is necessary, you can raise your concern outside the organisation. Be mindful that “where you decide to raise your concerns will have an impact on whether you have protection under the Public Interest Disclosure Act 1998 (PIDA)”. [taken from Protect website].

- This legislation allows certain categories of worker to lodge a claim for compensation with an employment tribunal if they suffer as a result of speaking up.
- The legislation is complex and to qualify for protection under it, very specific criteria must be met in relation to who is speaking up, about what and to whom.
- To help you consider whether you might meet these criteria, please seek independent advice from the charity [Protect](#) or a legal representative.

You can speak up externally to:

- [Care Quality Commission](#) (CQC) for quality and safety concerns about the services it regulates – you can find out more about how the CQC handles concerns [here](#).
- [NHS England](#) for concerns about:
 - GP surgeries
 - dental practices
 - optometrists
 - pharmacies
 - how NHS trusts and foundation trusts are being run (this includes ambulance trusts and community and mental health trusts)
 - NHS procurement and patient choice
 - the national tariff

NHS England may decide to investigate your concern themselves, ask your employer or another appropriate organisation to investigate (usually with their oversight) and/or use the information you provide to inform their oversight of the relevant organisation. The precise action they take will depend on the nature of your concern and how it relates to their various roles. Please note that neither the Care Quality Commission nor NHS England can get involved in individual employment matters, such as a concern from an individual about feeling bullied.

- [NHS Counter Fraud Agency](#) for concerns about fraud and corruption, using their [online reporting form](#) or calling their freephone line **0800 028 4060**.
- A relevant professional body for professional conduct concerns (such as the General Medical Council, Nursing and Midwifery Council, Health & Care Professions Council, General Dental Council, General Optical Council or General Pharmaceutical Council.)

5.2 How should I speak up?

- 5.2.1** You can speak to any of the people or organisations listed in 5.1 in person, by phone or in writing (including email and the online Speak Up form (see 5.1.1))
- 5.2.2** Confidentiality - the most important aspect of your speaking up is the information you can provide, not your identity. You have a choice about how you speak up:
- **Openly:** you are happy that the person you speak up to knows your identity and that they can share this with anyone else involved in responding.
 - **Confidentially:** you are happy to reveal your identity to the person you choose to speak up to on the condition that they will not share this without your consent. There may be occasions where we are unable to keep your identity confidential, for example if the law requires us to. Please be assured your information will always be treated with respect and only shared on a need-to-know basis and with your knowledge.
 - **Anonymously:** you do not want to reveal your identity to anyone. You can choose to raise your concern anonymously, without giving anyone your name, but that may make it more difficult for us to investigate thoroughly, offer you support and provide feedback on the outcome. All concerns raised are taken seriously, including those raised anonymously, and will be acted upon, where appropriate.
- 5.2.3** In all circumstances, please explain as fully as you can, the information and circumstances that prompted you to speak up.

5.3 Advice and Support

- 5.3.1** You can find out about the local support available to you from [Our People Hub. our.people@covwarkpt.nhs.uk](mailto:our.people@covwarkpt.nhs.uk) Tel: 07391 412403
- 5.3.2** Your local [staff networks](#) can be a valuable source of support.
- 5.3.3** You can also contact the following organisations:
- [Speak Up Direct](#) provides free, independent, confidential advice on the speaking up process.
 - The charity [Protect](#) provides confidential and legal advice on speaking up.
 - The [Trades Union Congress](#) provides information on how to join a trade union.
 - The [Law Society](#) may be able to point you to other sources of advice and support.
 - The [Advisory, Conciliation and Arbitration Service](#) (ACAS) gives advice and assistance, including on early conciliation regarding employment disputes

- 5.3.4** You can access national health and wellbeing support via NHS England:
- [Support available for our NHS people](#).
- 5.3.5** NHS England has a [Speak Up Support Scheme](#) that supports workers who are experiencing difficulty moving forward after a speak up process.

Listening Up

5.4 What will we do?

Listening and responding

- 5.4.1** Whether colleagues speak up more informally (e.g., through everyday conversations, supervision) or concerns are raised more formally, a proportionate response is required and should follow this same process.
- 5.4.2** The person receiving the information (or a request to meet to discuss any concerns) will:
- aim to acknowledge and respond within 72 hours or within 24 hours if the matter is more urgent (Please remember to incident report any urgent safety matters and escalate out of hours through the on-call system)
 - provide a safe space to listen, explore and understand the issues/concerns
 - explore options and ideas for resolution/solutions and identify next steps,
 - involve other relevant colleagues in discussions where necessary
 - ensure you receive feedback
- 5.4.3** If the matter you are speaking up about may be best considered under another policy/process, we will discuss that with you (for example, the patient safety framework, safeguarding procedures or an employee relations process to resolve individual issues).
- 5.4.4** Where an investigation is needed:
- where appropriate, we will involve the Freedom to Speak Up Guardian in planning the terms of reference and discuss this with you also
 - it will be objective and conducted by someone who is suitably independent (this might be someone outside the organisation or from a different part of the organisation) and trained in investigation
 - it will reach a conclusion within a reasonable timescale (which we will notify you of), and a report will be produced that identifies any issues to prevent problems recurring
- 5.4.5** If any employment issues are identified during the investigation, these will be considered separately. For example, capability or conduct implications

Communicating with you

- 5.4.6** We will always treat you with respect and will thank you for speaking up.

5.4.7 If we decide to investigate, we will tell you how long we expect the investigation to take and agree with you how to keep you up to date with its progress.

5.4.8 Wherever possible we will share the outcomes of the investigation and the report with you (while respecting the confidentiality of others and recognising that some matters may be strictly confidential).

Following Up

5.5 Outcomes, learning and feedback

5.5.1 We want speaking up to improve patient care and staff experience and those involved in responding to speak up matters will seek assurance that the appropriate action has been taken.

5.5.2 Where improvement opportunities are identified, we will ensure necessary changes are made, and are working effectively.

5.5.3 Learning will be shared with teams across the organisation and the Freedom to Speak Up Guardian.

5.5.4 We will seek feedback from workers about their experience of speaking up.

Escalation

5.5.5 If resolution has not been achieved, or you are not satisfied with the outcome, you can escalate the matter to the executive lead or the non-executive lead for Freedom to Speak Up). The Freedom to Speak Up Guardian can support you with this if needed.

5.5.6 Alternatively, if you think there are good reasons not to use internal routes, speak up to an external body, such as the CQC or NHS England

5.6 Senior leaders' oversight

5.6.1 The Freedom to Speak Up Guardian reports twice a year to our Safety and Quality Committee and Trust Board providing a thematic overview of speaking up.

5.6.2 The [annual report](#) is available on the Trust Intranet

6. Consultation

6.1 This main framework of this policy was developed nationally by NHS England, with support from the National Guardians Office. This included consultation with Freedom to Speak Up Guardians across England.

6.2 Locally we have developed this policy further and are developing a toolkit to support its implementation using quality improvement methodology and working in collaboration with a range of workers across the Trust including the Speak Up Project Group, Speak Up Champions and our Staff Networks.

- 6.3** All Trust staff have the opportunity to comment upon the policy via consultation on the intranet and it has been discussed at
- Joint Negotiating and Consultative Committee (JNCC)
 - Joint Local Negotiating Committee (JNLC)
 - Policy Ratification Group

7. Implementation

Managers are responsible for ensuring that this policy is implemented into working practice within their areas.

8. Training and Support

8.1 We ask all our workers to complete the national online training modules relevant for their role which you can access on ESR if you are employed by CWPT or through [e-learning for health](#).

8.1.1 [Speak Up](#) is for all workers to complete

8.1.2 [Listen Up](#) is specifically for managers to complete

8.1.3 [Follow Up](#) is for senior leaders to complete.

8.2 Further leadership development opportunities are available from the Freedom to Speak Up Guardian through our Listening Leaders programme which forms part of our Talent Management Leadership Pipelines offer.

8.3 Speak Up Champions will meet quarterly as a network and receive support and development opportunities coordinated by the Freedom to Speak Up Guardian.

9. Review

9.1 We will review the effectiveness of this policy and our local process every 3 years or to comply with changes in legislation or national guidance.

10. Monitoring and Compliance

Aspect of compliance or effectiveness being monitored	Monitoring method	Individual /department responsible for monitoring	Frequency of monitoring activity	Group /Committee which will receive findings/monitoring report	Group /Committee /individual responsible for ensuring that action is completed
Concerns raised	Central database	FTSU Guardian / lead executive for FTSU	Bi annual reporting	Safety & Quality Committee and Trust Board	Safety & Quality Committee and Trust Board
Effectiveness of policy/process	Feedback and measuring against baseline data	FTSU Guardian	Annually	Safety & Quality Committee and Trust Board	Safety & Quality Committee and Trust Board

11. References

- [NHS England » Freedom to speak up national policy, guidance and planning tool](#)
- [Learning from Case Reviews.pdf \(nationalguardian.org.uk\)](#)
- [Protect - Speak up stop harm \(protect-advice.org.uk\)](#)

12. Trust Associated Documents

The following documents can be found on our intranet [Policies and Toolkits](#)

- Incident Reporting Policy (Reporting, Managing and Investigating Incidents)
- Safeguarding Adults Policy
- Safeguarding Children and Young People Policy
- Duty of Candour Guidance
- Fraud, Bribery and Corruption Policy
- Grievance Policy
- Dignity at Work Policy

13. Version Control

Version	Date	Author (name and designation)	Status (Draft/Approved)	Comments
V6.0	10/11/2022	Suzanne Lawlor, Freedom to Speak Up Guardian	Draft	Whole policy rewrite in line with new National Speak Up Policy NHS England
V6.1	20/12/2022	Suzanne Lawlor, Freedom to Speak Up Guardian	Draft	Submitted to PRG for ratification
V6.2	03/01/2023	Suzanne Lawlor, Freedom to Speak Up Guardian	Draft	Amendments in response to feedback Submitted to JNCC/PRG for ratification
V6.3	01/02/2023	Suzanne Lawlor, Freedom to Speak Up Guardian	Approved	Approved by JNCC and ratified by PRG
V6.4	25/05/2023	Suzanne Lawlor, Freedom to Speak Up Guardian	Approved	Minor amendment to sections 4.5 and 4.6. Approved by PRG 07.06.2023
V6.5	21/06/2023	Suzanne Lawlor, Freedom to Speak Up Guardian	Approved	Minor amendment to section 5.1.1 executive lead responsibilities.

14. Equality Impact Assessment Form

Name of new / revised Policy / Strategy / Procedure	
Freedom to Speak Up	
Name of Author	
Suzanne Lawlor	
Directorate	
Nursing, AHP, and Quality	
IDENTIFYING ALL THE AIMS OF THE POLICY / STRATEGY /PROCEDURE	
CONSIDER THE EVIDENCE: Does the Policy / Strategy / Procedure affect one group less or more favourably than another on the basis of the protected characteristics, Please explain?	
Race	There may be barriers to speaking up for these groups. We recognise that speaking up for some groups of staff can be more challenging, including those with a protected characteristic, new starters, young workers, trainees and those who work shifts for example. This policy seeks to break down these barriers by promoting an inclusive approach, which encourages and supports speaking up for everyone.
Religion or Belief	
Gender reassignment	
Sex	
Sexual Orientation	
Age	
Disability (learning disabilities, physical disability, sensory impairment, and mental health problems)	
Marriage and civil partnership	
Pregnancy and maternity	
2. Where does responsibility for this Policy / Strategy / Procedure lie? Trust Board and Safety and Quality Committee will have oversight supported by the Executive and Non-Executive Leads for Freedom to Speak Up. The Freedom to Speak Up Guardian will work with colleagues to support implementation and monitor effectiveness.	
3. How will the Policy / Strategy / Procedure be put into effect? There will be a launch of the new policy and a toolkit to support its implementation.	
4. What criteria will you use to measure the effectiveness of the Policy / Strategy / Procedure? Numbers of people being aware of the policy, feedback on ease of use, feedback on speak up experiences, changes made as a result of speaking up. Triangulation with other safety, quality and workforce metrics. We hope to see a reduction in concerns being raised externally as a result of the new policy and toolkit.	
5. Which other Trust's Policy / Strategy / Procedure does this link with? Trust associated documents are listed in section 12 of the policy	
6. How has there been involvement and/or consideration of stakeholders from different groups in the development of this Policy / Strategy / Procedure YES/NO. Yes – this policy is based on the national framework. The policy and toolkit are being developed locally using QI methodology engaging with a range of stakeholders including the Speak Up Project Group, Speak Up Champions, and our Staff Networks.	
7. How will information pre and post consultation be available e.g., on the Intranet? Intranet, shared in In Brief – the policy will be also be published on the Trust Website so it is accessible to workers who are not directly employed by CWPT e.g. NHSP/agency workers	

IMPACT CHECKLIST
8. Are there factors other than elements of diversity which might help explain any adverse impact or use of this Policy / Strategy / Procedure There should be no adverse impact with this policy – the toolkit will include guidance that will seek to address the barriers we know exist for some groups. It will also be published on the Trust website to ensure availability for temporary, agency workers and students who may not have access to the Trust intranet.
9. How will the proposed Policy / Strategy / Procedure increase equality of opportunity for some groups or individuals? The policy is aimed at breaking down barriers so workers feel more able to speak up and ensuring when they do, a consistent process is followed. The toolkit will provide guidance for managers and leads hearing concerns to ensure they are aware of the aspects that make it more difficult for some groups and offers strategies to recognise and overcome these issues.
10. Are you confident that the Policy / Strategy / Procedure is lawful and can be justified? Explain The policy follows all the national guidance published by NHS England and National Guardians Office.
ALTERNATIVES CHECKLIST
11. Are there any alterations or additional measures which would remove or reduce adverse impact without effecting the Policy / Strategy / Procedure overall aims? No
12. If this Policy / Strategy / Procedure positively impacts a particular group, will any benefit to them outweigh the costs other groups? please explain. Not applicable
13. If you do not make above alterations, what are the consequences for the Partnership Trust or those individuals/groups? e.g., employment tribunal Not applicable
DECIDE WHETHER TO ADOPT THE POLICY / STRATEGY / PROCEDURE
14. What are the main findings of the consultation? Not yet completed
15. How will you change the policy / strategy / procedure to consider feedback from consultation and other information gathered? TBC
16. Who will be involved in the decision-making process of whether to adopt the Policy / Strategy / Procedure and why? Freedom to Speak Up Guardian, Exec and non-exec lead for FTSU, Policy Review Group
MONITORING
17. Consider piloting the Policy / Strategy / Procedure to assess impact why Yes or No The policy will be launched fully but it will remain an iterative process to get it right.
18. What criteria will be used to assess the effects on equality of opportunity and who will carry out the assessment? See section 4 – information collated will also include demographics so that we can monitor equality and pick up on any issues
21. How often will the Policy / Strategy / Procedure be reviewed and by whom? Annual review by Freedom to Speak Up Guardian supported by exec and non-exec leads for Freedom to Speak Up.

Date of Assessment	10/11/2022
Names and designations of the 3 people who contributed to this EIA assessment	1. Suzanne Lawlor - Freedom to Speak Up Guardian 2. Mary Mumvuri – Chief Nursing Officer 3. Rano Bains – Head of Equality, Diversity and Inclusion
Head of Equality, Diversity and Inclusion	Rano Bains
Date of Ratification	03/01/2023
Date of first review	13/01/2009

If you have identified a potential discriminatory impact on this procedural document, please refer it to the author of the policy or strategy, together with any suggestions as to the action required to avoid / reduce this impact. For advice in respect of answering the above questions, please refer to the guidance notes. **If the document affects one group less or more favourably, you MUST complete the full EIA form (i.e. if you have answered 'Yes' to any of the above).** The full EIA form can be obtained from the Equality and Diversity Department/website.

This policy, strategy, procedure or function has to go to the Head of Equality and Diversity for final sign off.

Please return a copy to the Equality and Diversity Department:
rano.bains@covwarkpt.nhs.uk